

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE CHANCE FACTOR IN LIFE AND SERVICE (ministry)

- Ephesians 5:16 **making the most of every opportunity**, because the days are evil. NIV
- Ephesians 5:16 **taking advantage of every opportunity**, because the days are evil. NET
- Colossians 4:5 Conduct yourselves with wisdom toward outsiders, **making the most of the opportunities**. NET
- **God given opportunities need to be grasped, taken.**

THE CHANCE FACTOR

- * I have used the terminology 'chance factor' as a way to describe those unexpected, unplanned events and happenings that appear without warning in our lives as we serve our living Christ.
 - So, this 'chance' means they appear unexpected, and untimely as far as our plans and schedule are concerned.
 - There is no sense of 'chance' from God's point of view because they are deliberately and carefully crafted with purpose and direction in them for us to grasp and take hold of.
- * Some time ago I was impacted by a statement that a well-known Christian lady - she said
"It seems that God is in the **INTERRUPTIONS** of my life and seldom in my plans",
(Gloria Gather as quoted by Mark Lowery)

NOTE:

- * In God's world there is no such things as "chance" or "Luck" or "coincidences"

* THERE ARE ONLY DIVINE APPOINTMENTS BRILLIANTLY DISGUISED AS INTERRUPTIONS

- * Those things that we view as being **interruptions** are often **God-given opportunities to us**.
 - Those unexpected things, events, circumstances and chance meetings with people, that we view as **Interruptions**, could really be **opportunities made available to us by God** to respond to and made the most of for the Kingdom.
- ▲ **BUT WE OFTEN DON'T SEE THEM AS OPPORTUNITIES** because we have already prayed and committed our day to the Lord.
- ▲ **OR WE ARE TOO OCCUPIED, BUSY WITH** other planned duties and responsibilities and so we fail to take hold of them.
- ▲ **SO THOSE UNPLANNED EVENTS THAT APPEAR BEFORE US ARE SEEN AS TO US AS NOTHING MORE THAN AN INTERRUPTION.**
- **BUT GOD IS OFTEN IN THOSE SO-CALLED INTERRUPTIONS, THOSE UNSCHEDULED, UNPLANNED THINGS THAT JUST APPEAR IN THE COURSE OF OUR NORMAL DAILY LIVES.**
- ▲ **THESE INTERRUPTIONS I HAVE REFERRED TO AS THE "CHANCE FACTOR" IN OUR LIVES AND IN OUR PATHWAY OF SERVING CHRIST.**
- This is an area where many Christians **fail to take advantage of those hidden opportunities disguised as interruptions** and do great things for the Christ's Kingdom cause.
 - ◆ **Charles Hadden Spurgeon said, "I tremble as I think how poverty-stricken my life has been, compared with my opportunities."**
- That is a very challenging statement from such a prince of preachers.

NOTE: There are no lucky or good fortune events in God's world all are deliberately designed and purposed.

- ▲ However, many believers struggle with concept of the 'change factor' being a normal part of their journey of living and serving Christ, **but there is no need to be because it was part of the life and ministry of Jesus.**

INTERRUPTIONS (examples)

Please note these phrases, 'IT HAPPENED', - BY CHANCE, PASSING BY, - AS THEY WENT, - WHILE ENTERING.

* **Happened** – its meaning from Webster's dictionary 1913 states - **to come by chance, - to come without previous expectation - to take place - to occur / appear, to crop up.**

1. IT ALSO HAPPENED – as he entered the synagogue.

There was a man with a **withered hand**. **Luke 6:6 It also happened** on another Sabbath, that he entered into the synagogue and taught. There was a man there, and his right hand was withered.

NKJV

2. IT HAPPENED - on Jesus' way to Jerusalem.

The 10 Lepers that met Jesus. **Luke 17:12-14 It happened**, as he was on his way to Jerusalem, that he was passing along the borders of Samaria and Galilee. As he entered into a certain village, ten men who were lepers met him, who stood far away. They lifted up their voices, saying, "Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!"

3. IT HAPPENED - when Jesus was in one of the cities.

One leper man came to Jesus. **Luke 5:12 It happened**, while he was in one of the cities, behold, there was a man full of leprosy. When he saw Jesus, he fell on his face, and begged him, saying, "Lord, if you want to, you can make me clean."

4. AS HE JOURNEYED/ TRAVELLED.

The Samaritan and the man dying by the roadside.

Luke 10:33 But a Samaritan, as he journeyed, came to where he was, and when he saw him, he had compassion. **ESV**

Luke 10:33 But a Samaritan, as he travelled, came where the man was; and when he saw him, he took pity on him. NIV

5. WHILE JESUS WAS ON HIS WAY - to Jairus' house.

The lady in the crowd with issue of blood for 12 years.

Luke 8:42-43

42 **Jairus' only daughter**, about twelve years old, was dying. **While Jesus was on his way to Jairus' house**, the people were crowding all around him. 43 **A woman was in the crowd who had been bleeding for twelve years**, but no one was able to heal her. **NCV**

6. AS HE WAS ENTERING THE CITY GATE of Nain – It happened

The widow and her dead son in the coffin – raised to life.

Luke 7:11-15

11 **Now it happened**, the day after, that He went into a city called Nain; and many of His disciples went with Him, and a large crowd. 12 And when He came near the gate of the city, behold, a dead man was being carried out, the only son of his mother; and she was a widow. And a large crowd from the city was with her. 13 When the Lord saw her, He had compassion on her and said to her, "Do not weep." 14 Then He came and touched the open coffin, and those who carried him stood still. And He said, "Young man, I say to you, arise." 15 He who was dead sat up and began to speak. He gave him to his mother. **NKJV**

7. JESUS - JUST PASSING THROUGH.

Just passing through and he met Zacchaeus

Luke 19.1:2 He entered and was passing through Jericho. There was a man named **Zacchaeus**. He was a chief tax collector, and he was rich. **NIV**

This encounter was totally unplanned in the natural, but Jesus responded to this interruption to his schedule and brought salvation and a completely changed life to **Zacchaeus**

Opportunities

- * Our lives are filled with opportunities but there is an important question that we must all ask ourselves and that is how many opportunities we have failed to see and to take advantage of.
- * So often we miss amazing opportunities to do good, show kindness and love all because we viewed certain unplanned events in our daily journey as nothing more than an interruption.
- * In doing so we missed the privilege of what God planned for us to participate in – **AMEN – Ps Barry**